

Direct UPI + WhatsApp payment — executive review

Taste of Andhra / multi-tenant restaurant SaaS

Audience: Leadership / ops / product (go / no-go)	Date: 2026-08-16
Status: Proposal for review — not yet fully productized	Related: WhatsApp Meta setup · Features & flow · Architecture gates

1. Decision needed

Approve a **zero / near-zero cost payment path** for small restaurants that:

- 1. Lets the restaurant receive money on **their own UPI ID** (no Razorpay / gateway fee on food orders).
- 2. Optionally sends a **WhatsApp payment link** when the order is placed (Cloud API).
- 3. Relies on **restaurant confirmation** (or customer “I’ve paid” + staff verify) to mark the order paid.

Optional later: Razorpay (or similar) as a paid add-on for restaurants that want auto-confirmation, cards, and wallets.

2. Why this path

Goal	How this helps
Onboard margin-sensitive restaurants	No 1.5–2%+ gateway fee on every order
Go live online quickly	Restaurant already has a UPI ID / bank QR
Low order volume	WhatsApp Utility cost is typically a few paise per message in India
Keep SaaS credible	Clear payment status in admin; kitchen/dispatch rules still enforced

Hard limit: UPI alone does **not** notify our app when money arrives. Auto “paid” without a PSP is not possible. Confirmation is an **ops step**, not a bank webhook.

3. Recommended product package

Default (recommended for small restaurants)

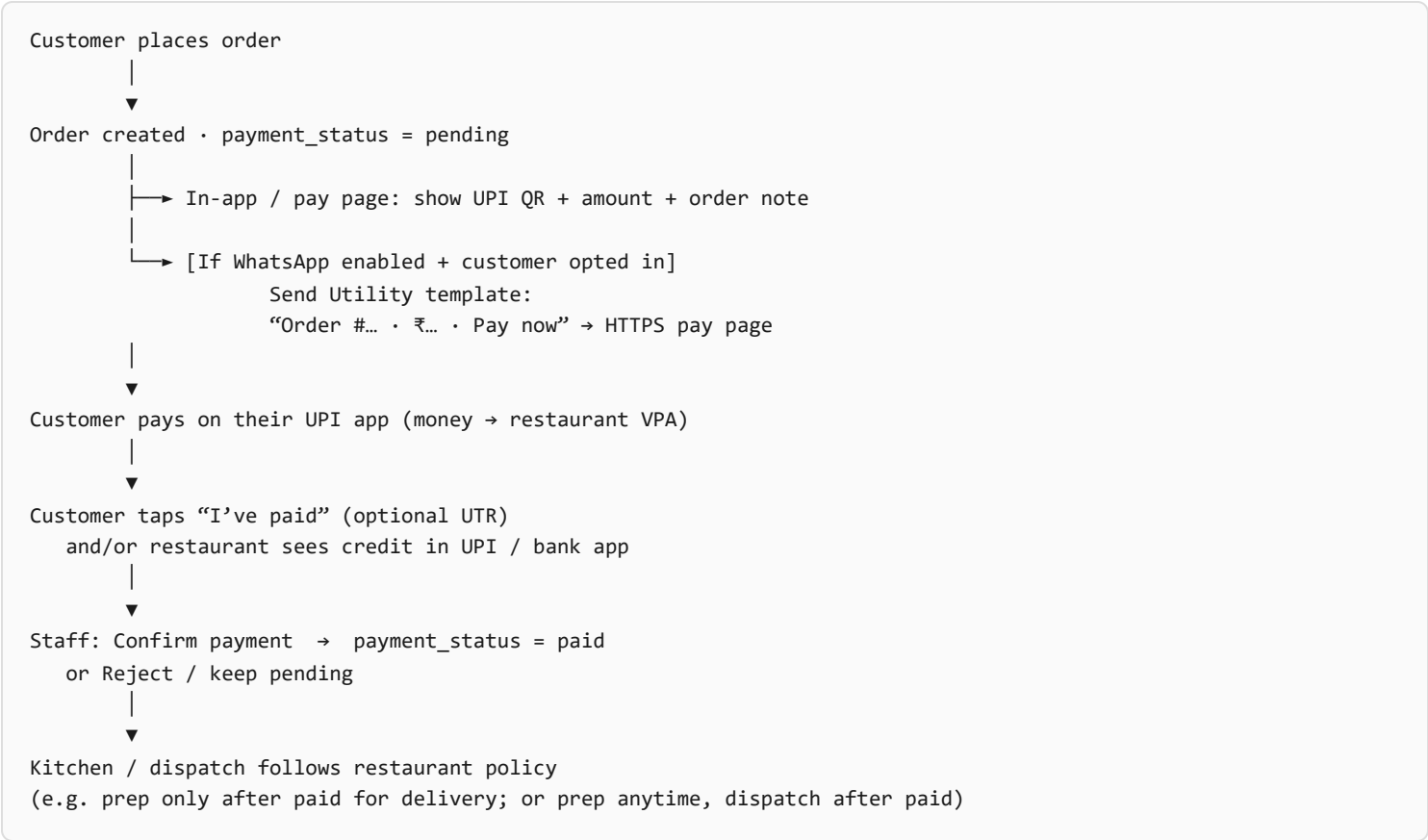
Capability	Included	Cost to restaurant
Save restaurant UPI ID + payee name	Yes	₹0
Checkout: Pay by UPI (dynamic QR / intent on order / pay page)	Yes	₹0
Optional: WhatsApp Utility message with Pay now (HTTPS pay page)	Yes (toggle)	~₹0.12 / delivered Utility msg outside free window*
Customer "I've paid" (optional UTR)	Yes	₹0
Admin / staff Confirm payment / Reject	Yes	₹0
COD / pay at counter	Yes	₹0

*India Utility template rates are set by Meta and change over time; Utility inside an open 24-hour customer-care window is often free.

Optional add-on (later)

Capability	When
Razorpay / other PSP (auto paid via webhook, cards, wallets)	Restaurant accepts gateway fees

4. End-to-end flow (for review)



What this is not

- Not “customer shares order on WhatsApp and we scrape confirmation.”
- Not automatic bank verification.
- Not a replacement for Razorpay when the restaurant wants auto-settled online status.

5. Actor responsibilities

Actor	Responsibility
Platform (us)	Host pay page + QR; enqueue WhatsApp template; store pending/paid; admin confirm UI; opt-in checks
Restaurant admin	Connect WhatsApp Business (Meta); save UPI ID; decide prep/dispatch rules; confirm payments
Customer	Pay via UPI; optionally mark “I’ve paid”; receive WhatsApp only if opted in
Kitchen / counter	Trust payment status (and printer tickets) before treating order as paid

6. WhatsApp specifics (exec summary)

Topic	Detail
Channel	WhatsApp Business Platform (Cloud API) — already in product for order-status templates
Trigger	Order created with UPI / pay-later pending (not a manual “share order” action)
Message type	Approved Utility template (transactional: order + amount + pay link)
Link in message	HTTPS pay page on our domain (shows QR). Raw upi:// is unreliable as a template button URL
Opt-in	Only if customer opted into WhatsApp updates
Reminders	At most one gentle reminder if still unpaid (quality / spam risk)
Payment truth	Delivery of WhatsApp ≠ money received

Restrictions / risks to acknowledge

1. Meta must **approve** the payment template; promo-like wording can be rejected or billed as Marketing (higher cost).
2. New WhatsApp numbers have **messaging limits** until quality/usage grows.
3. Misuse (broadcast payment spam) hurts **quality rating** and can throttle the number.
4. Restaurant must complete Meta Business / WABA setup (one-time ops effort).

7. Ops policy choices (need exec preference)

Pick defaults for v1; restaurants can override later if needed.

Policy question	Option A (safer)	Option B (faster kitchen)
When to start cooking (delivery)	Only after paid	Immediately; block dispatch until paid
When to start cooking (pickup)	After paid or at counter	Allow unpaid; settle at pickup
Unpaid timeout	Auto-cancel after N minutes	Keep pending; staff cancels
First-time customers	Must pay before prep	Same as regulars

Recommendation for small delivery-first restaurants: Option A for delivery; Option B for pickup/COD mix.

8. Cost illustration (low volume)

Assumptions: India recipients, Utility template ~₹0.115 when billed, 50 UPI orders/day, 1 payment WhatsApp per order, no reminder.

Item	Estimate
Gateway fee on UPI via restaurant VPA	₹0
WhatsApp Utility (50 × ₹0.115)	~₹6 / day (~₹180 / month)
If many customers already in 24h chat window	Often lower / free for those sends

Compare: 2% gateway on ₹50,000 GMV/day ≈ ₹1,000 / day. For margin-sensitive tenants, WhatsApp + manual confirm is usually far cheaper.

9. Fraud / ops risk

Risk	Mitigation
Fake "I've paid"	Staff confirm against UPI app / UTR before paid
Wrong amount / wrong note	Dynamic QR with exact amount + order # in note
Order cooked then no payment	Policy: prep or dispatch only after confirm
Staff delay confirming	WhatsApp alert to restaurant + pending queue in admin
Personal UPI limits / KYC	Prefer restaurant business UPI / bank merchant QR

10. Implementation snapshot (current vs proposed)

Piece	Today (approx.)	Proposed
Restaurant UPI ID in setup	Exists	Keep
UPI QR / pay-later helpers	Exists	Use as primary online path for free tier
Razorpay	Exists / gated	Optional paid upgrade
WhatsApp order-status templates	Exists	Add payment_pending (or similar) Utility template
Auto mark paid from UPI	Not possible without PSP	Do not promise
Admin confirm paid	Needed / extend	Required for this model

11. Phased rollout

Phase	Scope	Outcome
P0	UPI QR on pay page + admin Confirm paid + clear pending queue	Zero-cost live path
P1	WhatsApp Utility "Pay now" on order create (opt-in + toggle)	Better conversion when customer leaves site
P2	Optional single reminder; kitchen/dispatch gates by policy	Tighter ops
P3	Optional Razorpay add-on for tenants who want auto-paid	Upsell, not blocker

12. Confirmation checklist (executives)

Please mark and return:

#	Decision	Approve? (Y/N)	Notes
1	Offer Direct UPI + manual confirm as default for small restaurants		
2	Keep Razorpay optional (not required to go live)		
3	Allow WhatsApp payment link on order create (Utility + HTTPS pay page)		
4	Default kitchen policy for delivery: prep only after paid / dispatch only after paid (circle one)		
5	Cap unpaid WhatsApp nudges to 1 reminder		
6	Platform may bill tenants a small comms pass-through for Meta WhatsApp (optional commercial model)		
7	Target first pilot restaurants: _____		

Signed / dated: _____

13. One-line summary for stakeholders

Small restaurants receive payment on their own UPI; we send an optional WhatsApp pay link and keep order payment pending until staff confirms the credit—near zero cost, no gateway margin hit, with Razorpay available later if they want full automation.